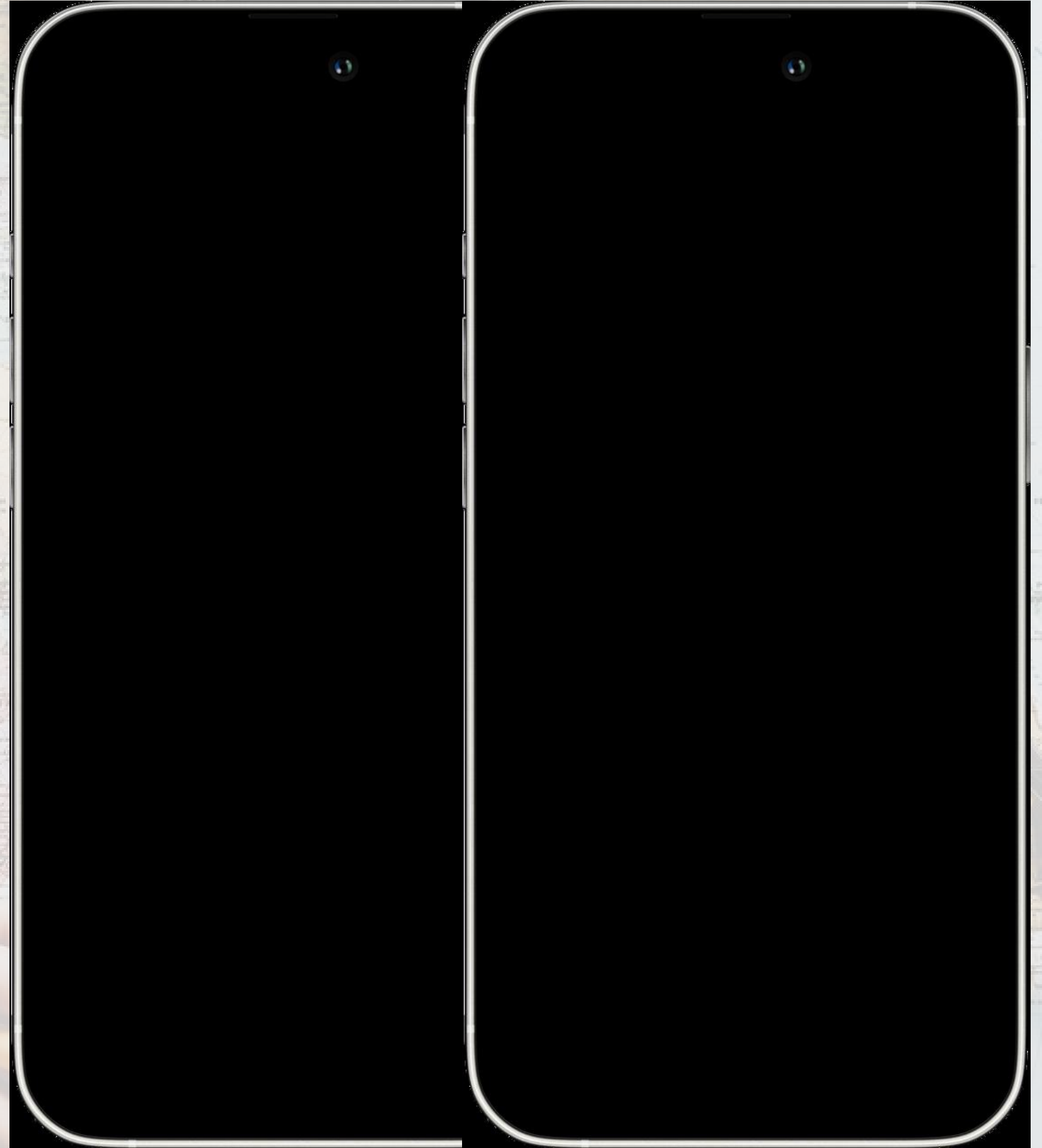




Case Study



Overview

Problem Breakdown

About



is an Indian online travel company, which was founded in 2000. The company provides online travel services including airline tickets, holiday packages, hotel reservations, rail and bus tickets.

Key Stats

69 Mn+
Lifetime Transaction

68 Mn+
Monthly Active Users

2,000
Cities Covered via Hotels

3/10
Domestic Flyers Book using it

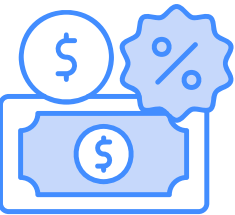
1,250
Cities Covered via Homestays

3.93
Pages/Visit

40.74%
Bounce Rate

7:27 min
Average Session Duration

Business Model



Commission based



Sales based



Subscription based



Advertisement based

Competitors



[Competitors analysis](#)

Actors



Users



MakeMyTrip



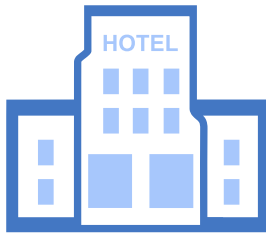
Airlines



Rental Cabs



IRCTC



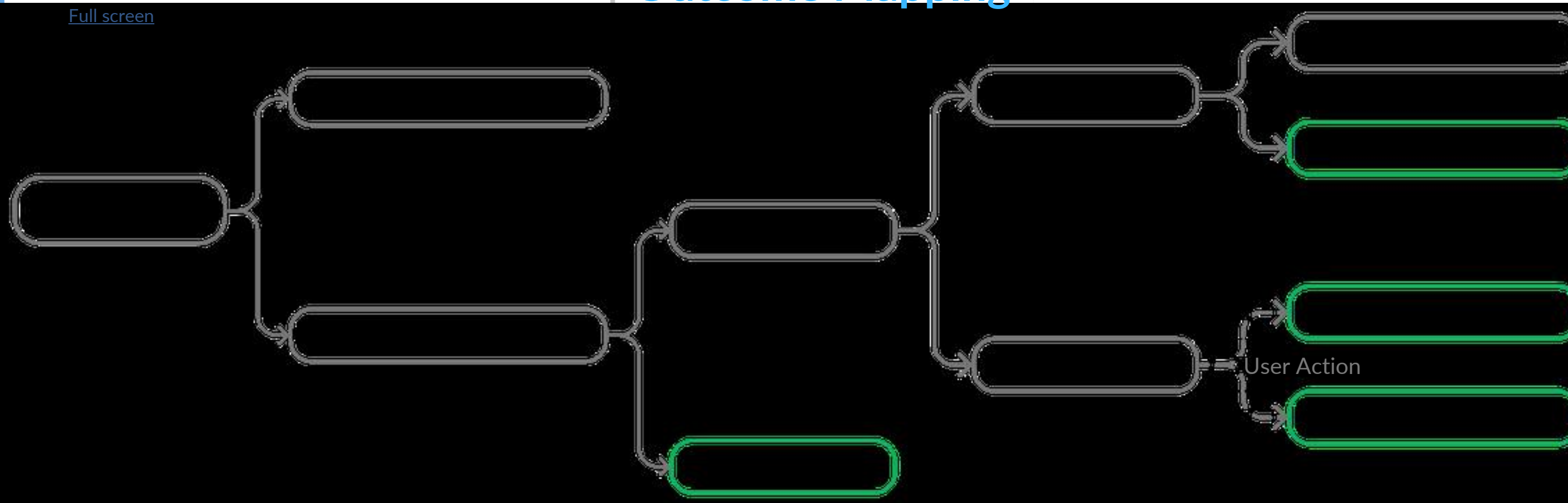
Hotels

Problem Statement

You are a product manager on the Growth team of the product you have chosen. The team has been given a mandate to focus on coming up with a solution that helps travellers to plan their trips/vacations since that is largely a problem that is yet to be solved in the industry. The team believes that with the advent of GenAI, a much more feasible and scalable solution can now be put forward.

Outcome Mapping

Full screen



Business Outcome

Increase Total number of bookings

Product Outcome

Increasing conversion rate
Reducing bounce rate
Increasing visit frequency
Increasing Average time spent

Problem Definition

In this age of technology, users are frustrated when planning trips because it remains a significant hassle. They must navigate back and forth between different websites to book flights, reserve hotels, and plan itineraries. This process involves a lengthy and complex user flow, which can be overwhelming and time-consuming. Moreover, if they want to visit a new place, they still have to conduct a significant amount of research, adding to the complexity and effort required.

Target Segment



- Tech Savvy Users
- Age: 20-30 Years
- Travels 2-3 times per year
- High Disposable Income
- Working professionals
- Value efficiency, convenience, and personalisation

Why solve it now?

Post-pandemic travel surge: There's a significant pent-up in demand for travel, creating a large market of users seeking efficient planning solutions.

Remote work trends: The rise of remote work and "workations" has created new travel planning needs that current fragmented solutions don't adequately address.

Secondary Research

- Travelers view 141 pages of travel content in the 45 days prior to booking a trip, and as high as 277 pages for travelers in the S., with these page views distributed throughout their path to purchase.
- In the early stages of planning, research is more spread out (about 2.5 page views per day), while it increases exponentially in the few days prior to a booking, ending with 25 page views on the day of purchase.

Exprt of US

Mar 18, 2024 | 12:00 am EDT

☆☆☆☆☆

A Personal Review of MakeMyTrip.com, Inc

As a frequent traveler, I recently had a disappointing experience with MakeMyTrip.com. The booking process was cumbersome, and the customer service was unresponsive. I faced issues with flight cancellations and refunds, which were not handled efficiently. The lack of transparency and poor communication left me frustrated. I would caution others to be wary of using their services, as my experience was far from satisfactory.

Pooja D

Reviewed 5 days ago

Make my trip is worst in package booking

Make my trip is pathetic in package booking..they upload fake pictures of hotels..Sangeeta thatari has misguided me,she booked worst hotel named Skyline hanoi hotel in Vietnam as per MMT is 3star but as per India it's exactly like 1 star Lodge..they doesn't serve breakfast in hotel..they said breakfast will be arranged near by street..Sangeeta told me that she doesn't have any idea about this hotel..just see how this company works???their employees doesn't have any information about hotel..Although it's very very difficult to reach their customer service..After knowing all my issues its been 5-6 days that neither they have changed the hotel nor giving me refund and they are not even answering my call.Pls do not book your package through MMT...

Snehasis Patra

06/04/24

They sell overpriced Holiday packages with no refunds. Beware of their practice of selling **holiday package** only gift cards that cannot be used for anything other than **holiday packages** booking on their site. All mentioned on tiny tnc fine print with no refund or replacement option.

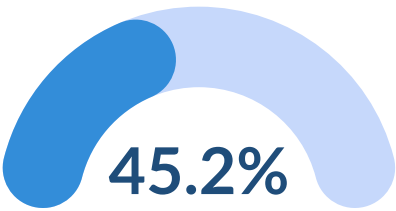
Hypothesis

Travelers face challenges in planning cohesive and personalized itineraries due to overwhelming options, fragmented booking processes, and budget concerns, leading to user dissatisfaction stemming from inconsistent service quality and misleading information.

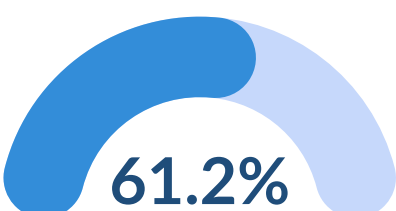
Survey Insights

[Survey Form](#) [User response](#)

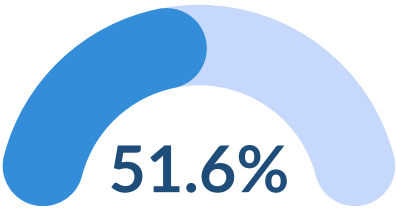
Uncovering the "What"



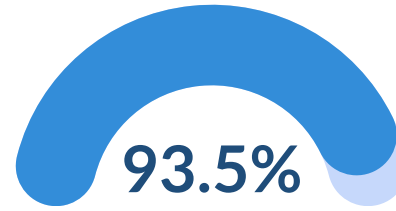
Travellers are burdened by too many options to choose from.



Travellers struggle to create a cohesive itinerary.



Travellers face lack of updated information.



Travellers rely on manual management and spreadsheets.

Interview Insights

[User Interviews](#)

Uncovering the "Why"

- Aditi's struggle with "weeks" of planning and still missing key attractions in Kerala highlights how excessive information hinders decision making.
- Mohan spent months on making an itinerary during his visit to Sikkim but a landslide because of heavy rainfall ruined his day indicating a lack of real-time updates leading to struggle in future vacation planning.
- Many users have experienced anxiety while researching for a vacation because the photos of bookings they've made in the past were often very different from the actual offerings.
- Multiple users dropped their travel plans because of budget constraints emphasising the issue of demand-based price hikes.

User Personas



Name: Aditi Saxena
Occupation: Brand Manager
Travel Style: Adventure-seeking and Budget-Conscious

Age: 24
City: Kolkata

Goal: To plan unique and fulfilling trips conveniently.

Pain Point: Difficulty choosing between options under budget and fear of missing out on key attractions.



Name: Mohan
Occupation: HR Manager
Travel Style: Seeks Relaxation and Values Convenience

Age: 28
City: Delhi

Goal: To have a smooth and enjoyable trip

Pain Point: Lacks information on alternatives to places on his itinerary and has a distrust of online information.

Jobs-to-be-done Statement

When I am planning a trip,

But I find it overwhelming to research all the different elements while ensuring I get the best value,

Please help me effortlessly plan and book my entire trip,

So I can enjoy a stress-free travel experience.

Problem Framing Canvas

What is the true problem?

Travellers find trip planning stressful and time-consuming due to information overload, difficulty crafting cohesive itineraries, and anxieties around unreliable information and hidden costs.

Who are the customers facing the problem?

- New age users accustomed to personalized experiences.
- Individuals seeking convenience.
- Users overwhelmed by the planning process.

How do we know it is a real problem?

- Survey insights reveal common pain points regarding choice overload, itinerary struggles, manual management, and outdated information.
- Interview insights provide real-life examples of these pain points leading to negative travel experiences and abandoned travel plans.

What is the value generated by solving this problem?

For the target customers:

- Reduced stress of travel planning.
- Increased confidence in choosing the right experiences.
- More enjoyable, fulfilling, and personalized trips.
- Transparency and peace of mind when booking.

For the business:

- Increased user engagement.
- Higher conversion rates and increased bookings.
- Reduced bounce rates and abandoned carts.
- Improved customer satisfaction and loyalty

Problem Framing

Solution

Wireframing

AI Trip recommendations

How it works: Users interact with a GenAI chatbot, providing travel preferences (dates, budget, interests, travel style, etc.) through natural conversation.

GenAI Power: The chatbot analyzes the input date, past travel data (if available), and a vast database of destinations, attractions, and reviews to generate a personalized recommendations..

PlanMytrip Itinerary dashboard

How it works: A single dashboard that aggregates all booking information (flights, accommodation, activities, transportation) into a unified itinerary.

GenAI Power: The AI automatically organises bookings chronologically, optimises routes for efficiency and suggests relevant activities based on location and schedule, using Google Map API and provides weather forecast, real-time updates and alerts about the unforeseen circumstances.

AI Budget Optimizer

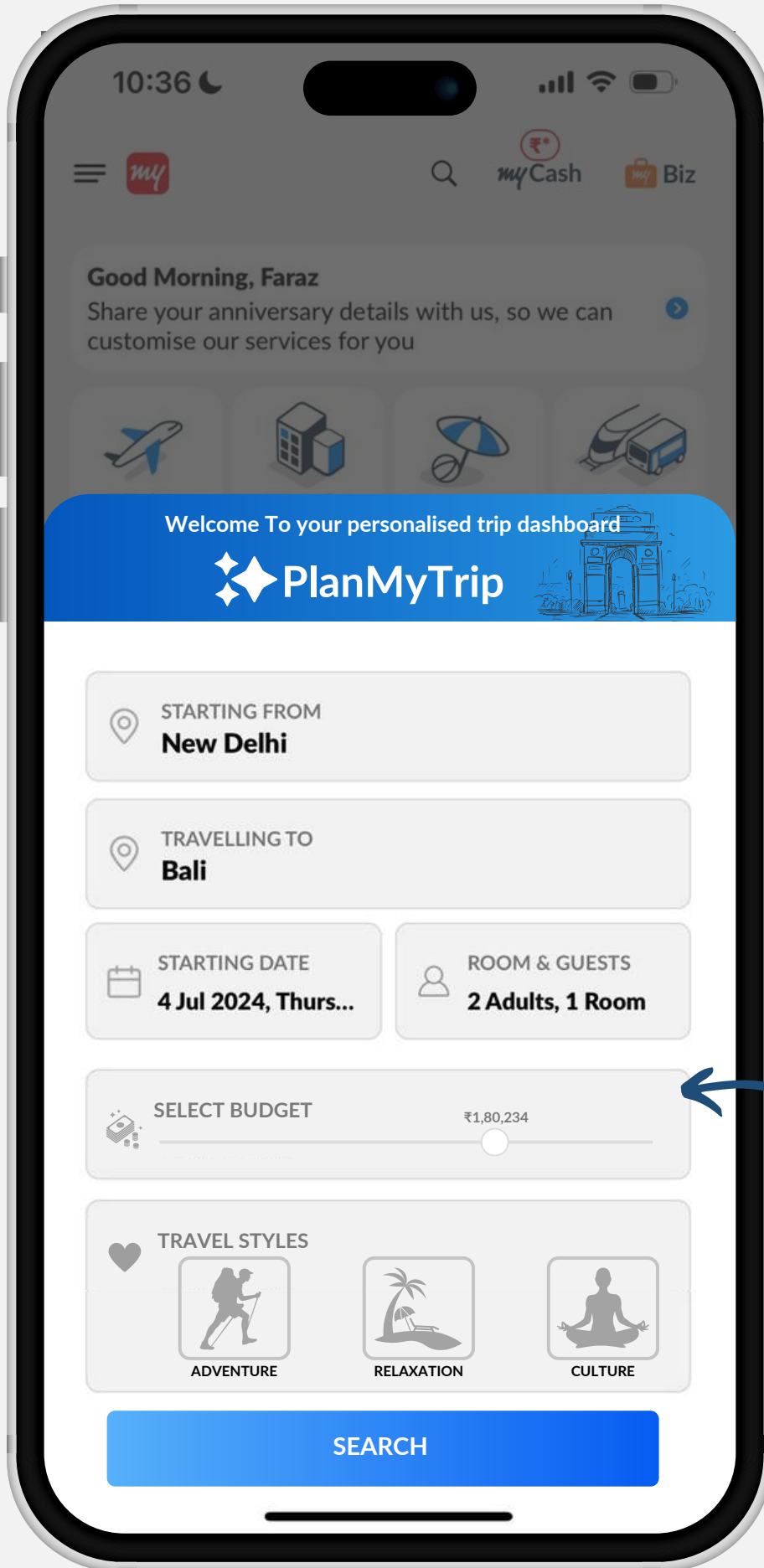
How it works: The tool integrates with the user's trip plan and budget, proactively searching for deals on flights, accommodation, and activities based on preferences.

GenAI Power: The AI analyzes price trends, predicts optimal booking times, and identifies personalized deals, taking the guesswork out of securing the best value.

Prioritisation

[Detailed prioritisation](#)

Feature	Impact Estimate	Confidence Score	Value Risk	Usability Risk	Feasibility Risk	Business Viability Risk	Overall Score
PlanMytrip Itinerary dashboard	5	5	3	2	3	2	20
AI Budget Optimizer	3	5	2	2	2	2	16
AI Trip recommendations	4	3	3	3	3	2	18

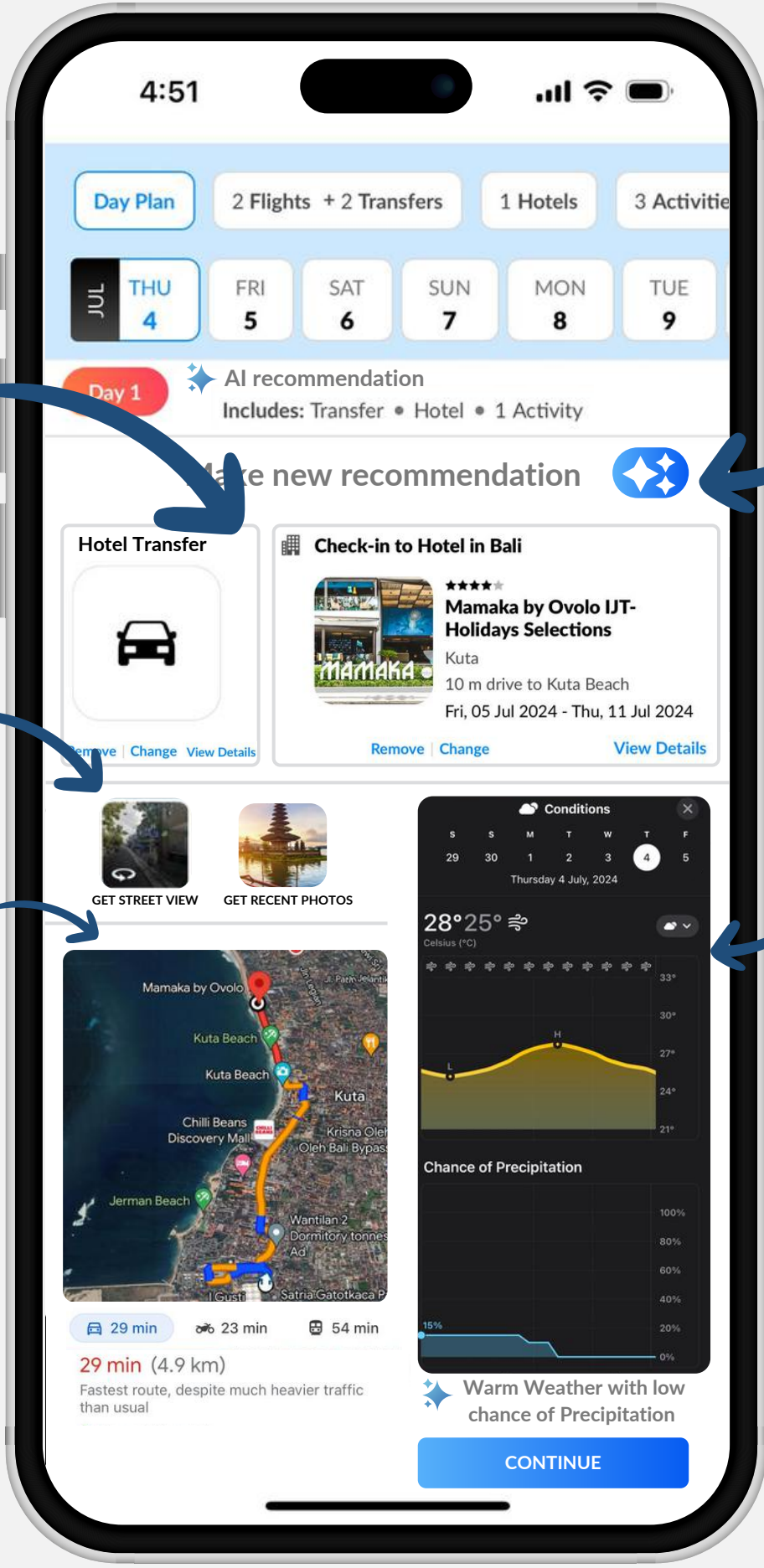


Users get AI recommendations based on their details.

Users can get street view and recent photos.

Users get ETA for the recommended destinations.

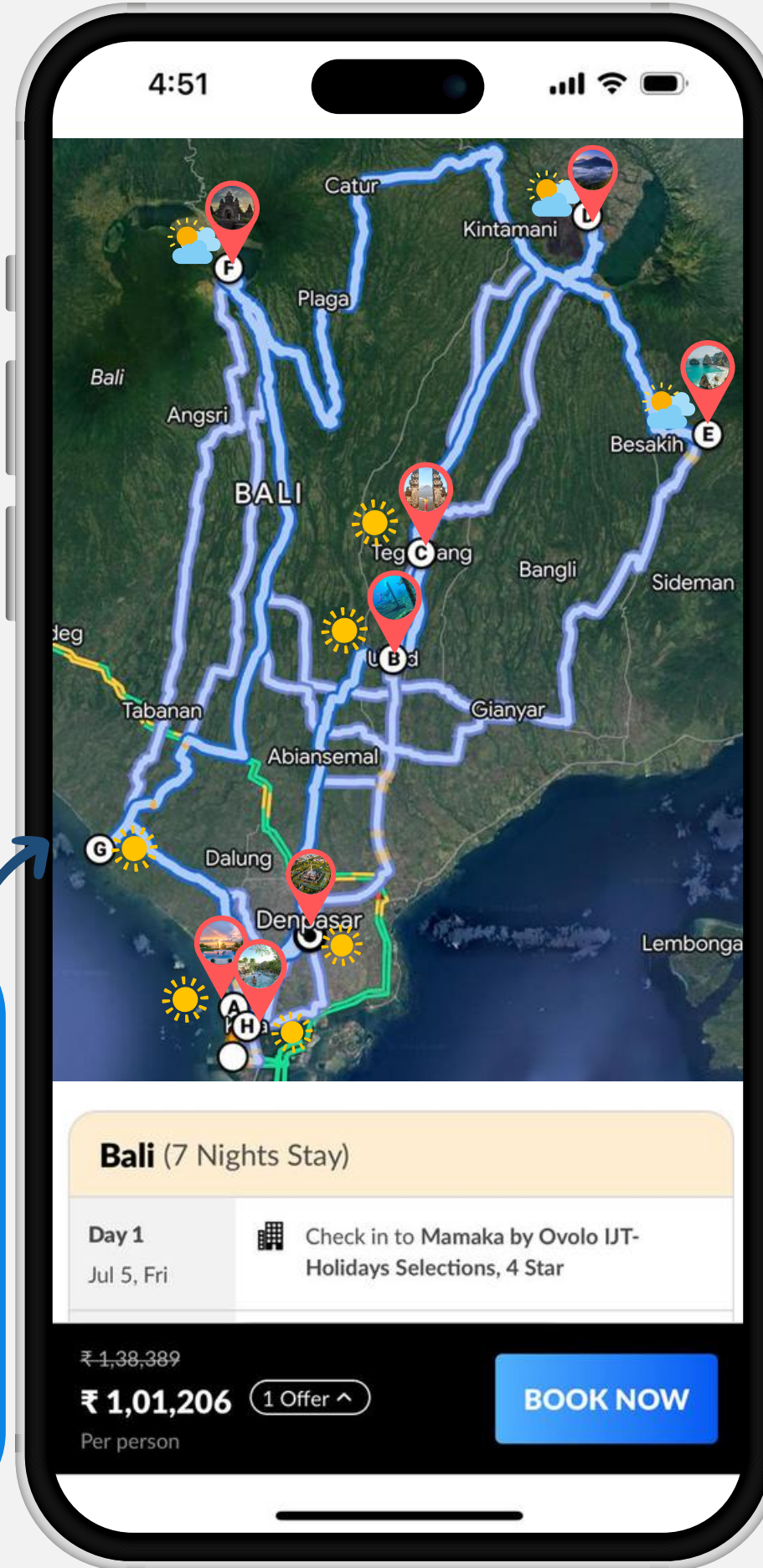
Users can add their details and can even select their budget and travel style.



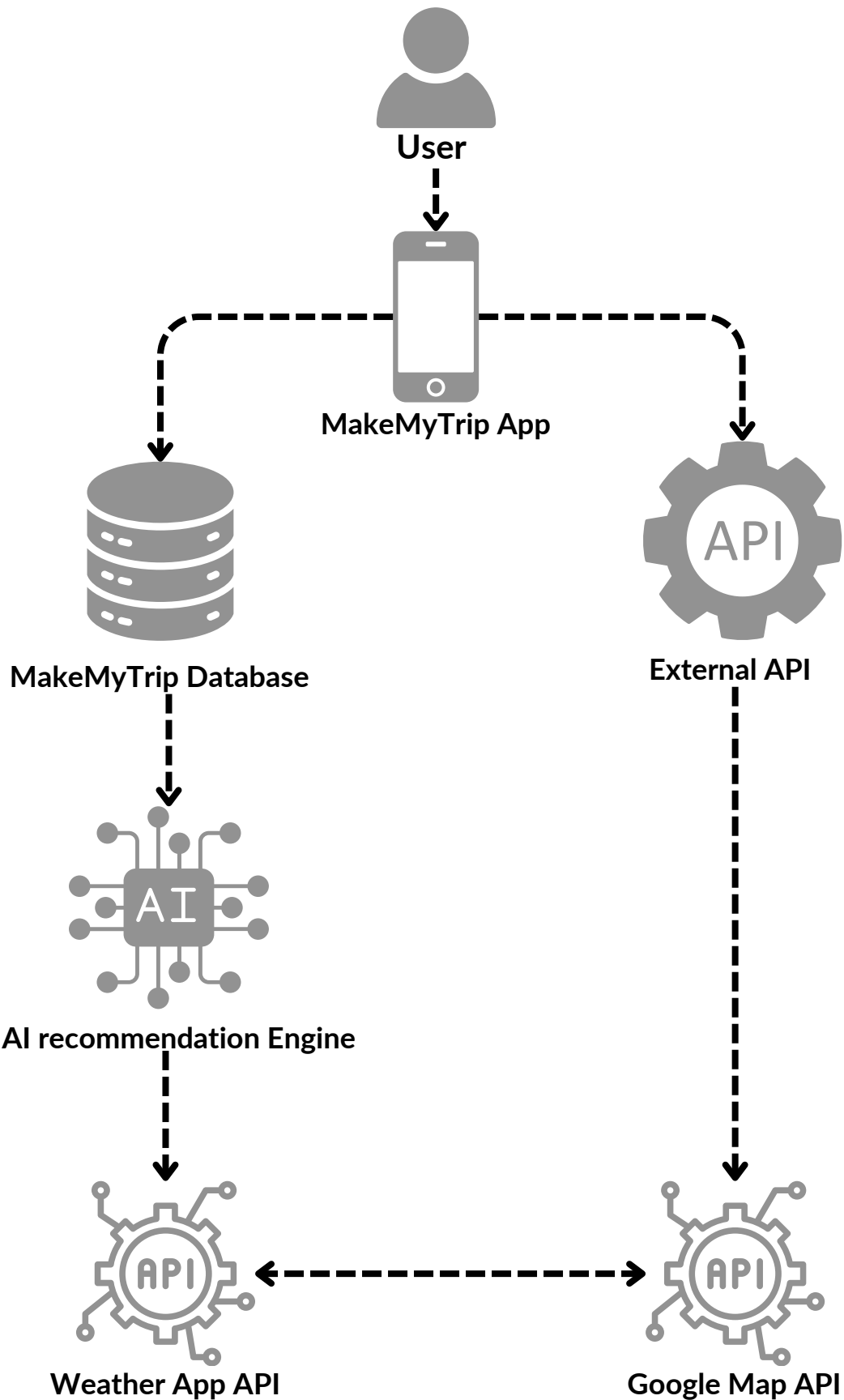
Users get new suggestions.

Users get weather forecast for the recommended destinations.

Users get entire itinerary with suggestions based on weather and real-time information using AI..



System Architecture



Metrics

Type	Metric	Goals
Engagement Metric	Dashboard adoption rate (# of users creating/using dashboard) / (# of total users)	Increase adoption.
	Bookings Integrated Per Trip (Total # of bookings linked to dashboard) / (# of trips planned)	Drive higher integration
	Itinerary Completion Rate (# of users creating complete itineraries) / (# of users starting a plan)	Improve completion rates
AI Performance	Personalized Recommendation Acceptance Rate (# of AI recommendations accepted/booked) / (# of recommendations presented)	Increase acceptance rate
Check metrics	API Integration Success Rate (# of successful API calls) / (total # of API calls)	Maintain a high success rate
	Data Accuracy & Timeliness Track % of discrepancies in real-time data) / (Frequency of data updates)	Minimize discrepancies

Pitfalls

1. Inaccurate Data: Relying on real-time data (e.g., weather, travel conditions) may lead to inaccuracies.

Mitigation:

- Implement a step-by-step guided flow that introduces information gradually.
- Provide customizable filters and settings to allow users to control the amount of data displayed.

2. Integration Issue: Limited Value Perception if Users Don't Integrate Bookings.

Mitigation:

- Clearly communicate the benefits of using the dashboard (e.g., centralized bookings, real-time updates, reduced stress).
- Offer incentives for users to connect their bookings (e.g., exclusive deals, loyalty points, personalized recommendations).
- Make connecting bookings as frictionless as possible. Explore options for automatic import of booking confirmations from email inboxes.

3. Lack of User Control: Over reliance on AI Leading to Inflexibility or Lack of User Control

Mitigation:

- Allow users to easily override AI-powered suggestions or make manual adjustments to their itineraries.
- Provide users with insights into how the AI generates recommendations and makes decisions, fostering trust and understanding.
- Combine AI-powered suggestions with traditional search and filtering options, giving users the flexibility to explore on their own terms.

Guardrails

- Regular user feedback sessions to ensure the interface remains user-friendly.
- A/B testing for optimal balance between comprehensive information and user simplicity.
- Use a modular design approach for easy updates and feature additions.
- Use API versioning to manage changes in external APIs and avoid disruptions.